We win the Test in Trinidad but the West Indies win the toss and elect to bat first in the third Test at Bridgetown, Barbados. Lara scores an imperious 176 in their total of 296 but, feeling confident and comfortable, I manage to score 178 in our reply. We win by an innings and 86 runs, and take a 2–0 lead in the series.

Life is great. The Caribbean is such a fun place that, for all our hard work, there are times when the tour almost feels like a holiday, happy times when we mess around on jet skis, or relax at the beach or play golf. I am beginning to believe this is the best tour ever: I'm scoring runs, the weather is great and the West Indian fans are knowledgeable and upbeat, dancing in the stands and having a good time even when their team is losing.

Graeme and I combine to produce another successful opening stand in the fourth Test at St John's on the island of Antigua, and we reach 245 without loss before I am dismissed for 114. The home team replies with an epic innings of 747 all out, a batting marathon during which all 11 members of our team have a chance to bowl.

With the match destined to end in a draw, I am asked to bowl 11 overs of 'baby seamers' before lunch and, to my horror, am then told to continue bowling into the afternoon, sending down another 10 overs. The experience of bowling no fewer than 21 overs in a row would leave me feeling sore and stiff for days afterwards, but I'm enjoying myself and, in a moment of pure delight, I am convinced I have trapped Dwayne Bravo LBW.

'Hooooooooooowzaaaaaaaaaaaaat!' I roar.

The ball seems to be hitting the middle of middle stump but the umpire says: 'Not out.'

Dismissing an established batsman like Bravo would have been memorable, but there is consolation when I take the wickets of two tail-enders, bowling Daren Powell for 12 and having Tino Best caught by Herschelle Gibbs for five. In the final analysis, my figures are 21 overs, six maidens, two wickets for 49 runs.